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NORTHWEST REGIONAL MODELING CONSORTIUM CHARTER

January 22, 2004
as revised May 2020

Introduction

In the early 1990's a group of Pacific Northwest air quality and weather prediction agencies began a collaboration to improve local weather forecasts by funding the installation and operation of a radar wind profiler to obtain upper air data in the Puget Sound region. By 1995 this consortium of agencies sponsored the development and implementation of an operational weather prediction system using a high-resolution mesoscale meteorological model. Recognizing the significant benefits derived from this initial prediction system, the consortium has continued to collaborate and cooperatively fund the further development and expansion of the system.

The consortium prediction efforts continue to grow with greatly expanded domains and products. Membership is dynamic but generally stable. New members are anticipated, and in an effort to hold down costs, a new mechanism has been created to permit access to gridded data to private sector interests and other non-member organizations for a fee.

This charter describes the purpose of the Northwest Regional Modeling Consortium (NRMC), and the framework within which it functions to achieve this purpose.

Purpose

The Northwest Regional Modeling Consortium facilitates collaboration among interested agencies to:

- improve local and regional environmental forecasts through the development, implementation, and evaluation of high-resolution mesoscale models for operational use,
- provide high quality mesoscale meteorological predictions and data bases to support environmental management and policy decisions in the Pacific Northwest, primarily Idaho, Washington and Oregon,
- provide user-friendly, web-based, interactive graphical and text displays of data and model products,
- coordinate with other regional modeling groups and organizations, as appropriate.

Organization and Membership

The Consortium conducts regular quarterly meetings for the purposes of collaboration, sharing relevant technical information, providing direction to funded projects, and conducting business to meet the interests of its members. Special meetings may be called as necessary.

The membership of the Consortium consists of Sustaining Members and Collaborative Members. A Sustaining Member is defined as an organization that has made regular financial and/or in-kind service contributions and demonstrates a long-term record of participation in Consortium work. A Collaborative Member regularly participates in meetings and makes financial or in-kind contributions on a short-term or project-specific basis. In-kind contribution is defined as organizational resources

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that perform work that results in products that contribute to consortium purposes. A Collaborative Member may become a Sustaining Member upon affirmation of the Sustaining Members.

Membership as of May 2020:

Sustaining Members:

Federal Government

U.S. Environmental Protection Agency, Region 10
U.S. Department of Agriculture / Forest Service / PNW Research Station
U.S. Department of Commerce / NOAA /National Weather Service

Tribes

Nez Perce Tribe
Swinomish Indian Tribal Community

State and Local Government

Idaho Department of Environmental Quality
Oregon Department of Environmental Quality
Oregon Local Air Agencies:

- Lane Regional Air Protection Agency

Washington State Department of Ecology
Washington State Local Air Agencies:

- Benton Clean Air Agency
- Northwest Clean Air Agency
- Olympic Regional Clean Air Agency
- Puget Sound Clean Air Agency
- Southwest Clean Air Agency
- Spokane Regional Clean Air Agency
- Yakima Regional Clean Air Agency

Washington State Department of Natural Resources
City of Seattle / Seattle City Light

Industry

King 5 Media Group

Institutions

University of Washington / Department of Atmospheric Sciences
Washington State University / Lab for Atmospheric Research

Collaborative Members:

Environment and Climate Change Canada, Pacific & Yukon Region

Past Members:

Oregon State Department of Forestry
Port of Seattle

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U.S. Navy
U.S. Department of Interior/National Park Service/Pacific West Region
British Columbia Ministry of Environment
Iberdrola Energy
Washington State Department of Transportation

Decision Making

Decisions by the Consortium will generally be made by consensus. In the rare event that consensus cannot be achieved, any Sustaining Member may call for a vote at any time on any issue of concern, providing that a quorum consisting of three-fifths of the total number of Sustaining Members is present. There is one vote per Sustaining Member. More than half of the Sustaining Members present must vote affirmatively for a motion to pass.

While the EPA is considered a sustaining member of NRMC, the EPA does not have a role in defining the technical work of the consortium. Therefore, EPA participants may offer technical advice and insight but will not advocate for particular technical approaches or have voting privileges. Rather, a designated EPA staff member acts as the Administrative Coordinator of the Consortium and assists the Consortium Technical Chair in collecting the viewpoints and votes of other members and communicating this information to other consortium members and air quality decision makers (e.g., the Northwest Air Directors and regional tribes).

Technical Chair and Administrative Coordinator

NRMC is managed by a Technical Chair and supported by an Administrative Coordinator. The Technical Chair will be reaffirmed annually or replaced by nominations from the floor and a vote by the Sustaining Membership. It is the responsibility of the Technical Chair to identify the needs of the membership and guide the technical direction of model and product development. It is the responsibility of the Administrative Coordinator to conduct the regular meetings and any special meetings of the Consortium, in cooperation with the Technical Chair. The Technical Chair may select a Vice Chair with the approval of the Sustaining Membership. An EPA technical staff member will serve as the permanent Administrative Coordinator.

The responsibilities of the Administrative Coordinator and Technical Chair are summarized in the following lists:

<u>Administrative Coordinator</u>:

- Track members' technical needs and communicate these to the Technical Chair;
- Maintain member communications (e.g., maintain the listserv);
- Facilitate charter updates, when needed;
- Facilitate transitions between incoming and outgoing technical chairs;
- Present updates on NRMC to air quality decision makers (e.g., Northwest Air Directors and regional Tribes), in coordination with the Technical Chair;
- Maintain a list of voting representatives for each sustaining member;
- Coordinate administrative planning efforts for the quarterly meetings; and

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- Perform outreach, as appropriate, to potential new NRMC members, in coordination with the Technical Chair.

Technical Chair:

- Develop quarterly meeting agendas, in coordination with the Administrative Coordinator;
- Lead development of the annual work plan and budget;
- Facilitate the quarterly meetings;
- Present updates on NRMC to air quality decision makers (e.g., Northwest Air Directors and regional Tribes), in coordination with the Administrative Coordinator;
- Lead the voting process for members' proposals; and
- Perform outreach, as appropriate, to potential new NRMC members, in coordination with the Administrative Coordinator.

Funding

Funding for the Consortium activities by interested government agencies and entities will be voluntary. This funding will support the core activities necessary to produce mesoscale meteorological predictions and grids. Individual members may also enter into support contracts with the University of Washington for new products and projects to take advantage of the Consortium infrastructure. These contracts shall not interfere with meeting routine operational expectations. Members acknowledge that the operation at University of Washington requires sustainable funding to operate and, if necessary, operations or specific projects may be suspended or terminated due to the unavailability of funding.

Funding from Non-Member Organizations

In an effort to hold down costs to Sustaining Members, the University of Washington may provide access to operational gridded data to non-members for an annual subscription fee. The Sustaining Members shall establish these fees. Each subscription must be disclosed by the University and reviewed by the Sustaining Membership for appropriateness to ensure the interests of the Consortium are not compromised. Subscriptions do not necessarily convey membership into the Consortium.

Non-Fund Obligating Document

This instrument is neither a fiscal nor a funds obligation document. Any endeavor involving reimbursement or contribution of funds between the parties to this instrument will be handled in accordance with the applicable laws, regulations, and procedures including those for Government procurement and printing. Such endeavors will be outlined in separate agreements that shall be made in writing by representatives of the parties and shall be independently authorized by appropriate statutory authority. This instrument does not provide such authority. Specifically, this instrument does not establish authority for noncompetitive award to the cooperator of any contract or other agreement. Any contract or agreement for training or other services must fully comply with all applicable requirements for competition.

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Disposition of Consortium Assets

Should the Consortium dissolve, the disposition of Consortium assets will be according to a process to be established by Sustaining Members, subject to legal constraints of agency regulations.

Additional Terms Concerning EPA Participation in the Consortium

All commitments made by EPA in this Charter are subject to the availability of appropriated funds. Nothing in this Charter, in and of itself, obligates EPA to expend appropriations or to enter into any contract, assistance agreement, interagency agreement, or incur other financial obligations that would be inconsistent with Agency budget priorities. All parties to this Charter waive any claim for compensation for services rendered to EPA in connection with any activities it carries out in furtherance of this Charter. This Charter does not exempt parties to the Charter from EPA policies governing competition for assistance agreements. Any transaction involving reimbursement or contribution of funds between EPA and the parties to this Charter will be handled in accordance with applicable laws, regulations, and procedures under separate written agreements.

Pursuant to Federal ethics rules, EPA employees may not, with limited exceptions, endorse or promote products or services offered by or provided by any non-federal entity. Nothing in this Charter constitutes an endorsement by EPA to any products or services, or any fundraising activity or promotion relating to other parties to the Charter. All parties to the Charter agree not to make statements to the public at workshops and meetings, promotional literature, on its web site or through any other media that imply that EPA or any of its employees endorses any commercial service or product offered by the NRMC or its members. In addition, the parties to the Charter agrees not to make statements that imply that EPA supports any party to the Charter's efforts to raise public or private funds. Any statements or promotional materials that describe this Charter must be approved in advance by EPA and the sustaining membership.

Document Review

This document shall be reviewed and reaffirmed or updated every five years by agreement of Sustaining Members.

Principal Contacts and Signatures of Sustaining Member Representatives

Cliff Mass

6/12/2020 *date*

Dr. Cliff Mass
Professor
Atmospheric Sciences Department
University of Washington
Seattle, WA

KRISHNASWAMY VISWANATHAN

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date

Krishna Viswanathan
Director
Air and Radiation Division
U.S. EPA Region 10
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6/01/20 *date*

Kathy Taylor
Air Quality Program Manager
Washington State Department of Ecology
Olympia, WA

6/23/2020 *date*

Ali Mirzakhalili
Air Quality Division Administrator
Oregon Department of Environmental Quality
Portland, OR

05/20/2020 *date*

Tiffany Floyd
Air Quality Division Administrator
Idaho Department of Environmental Quality
Boise, ID

06/15/2020 *date*

Christopher Keane
Vice President of Research
Washington State University
Pullman, WA

27 May 2021 *date*

Samuel N. Penney
Chairman
Nez Perce Tribal Executive Committee

PAUL ANDERSON Digitally signed by PAUL ANDERSON Date: 2020.07.31 12:12:08 -07'00' *date*

Paul Anderson
Station Director (Acting)
Pacific Northwest Research Station
USDA Forest Service
Corvallis, OR

10/7/2020 *date*

James Noblin
Chief Power Dispatcher
Seattle City Light
Seattle, WA

date

Rich Marriott
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10/13/2020 *date*

George Geissler
State Forester
Washington State Dept. Natural Resources
Olympia, WA

May 19, 2020 *date*

Craig Kenworthy
Executive Director
Puget Sound Clean Air Agency
Seattle, WA

August 31, 2020 *date*

Logan Johnson
Meteorologist in Charge
National Weather Service, Seattle Forecast Office
NOAA
Seattle, WA

June 9, 2020 *date*

Uri Papish
Executive Director
Southwest Clean Air Agency
Vancouver, WA

June 10, 2020 *date*

Keith Hurley
Executive Director
Yakima Regional Clean Air Agency
Yakima, WA

June 3, 2020 *date*

Julie Oliver
Executive Director
Spokane Regional Clean Air Agency
Spokane, WA

June 3,2020 *date*

Fran McNair
Executive Director
Olympic Regional Clean Air Agency
Olympia, WA

June 3, 2020 *date*

Mark Buford
Executive Director
Northwest Clean Air Agency
Mount Vernon, WA

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Robin Priddy

June 5, 2020 *date*

Robin Priddy
Executive Director
Benton Clean Air Agency
Kennewick, WA

Merlyn L. Hough

June 26, 2020 *date*

Merlyn Hough
Director
Lane Regional Air Protection Agency
Springfield, OR

Steve Edwards *date* 7-16-2020

Steve Edwards
Chairman
Swinomish Indian Tribal Community